

How can you communicate indicator and evaluation results within the wider strategic picture?

In DoView Planning, the idea is to keep an organization, agency, strategy, policy or initiative's DoView strategy/outcomes diagram at the heart of all decision-making. This ensures that planning, measurement and implementation are tightly aligned around the 'This-Then' logic of the initiative. The same approach is adopted when we turn to reporting back performance management and evaluation results. By reporting indicator and evaluation results back onto the initiative's DoView, those aiming to assess the initiative's progress can clearly see which steps in the initiative's 'This-Then' logic particular results relate to.

In the past, the tendency has been to report indicator results in spreadsheets or dashboards. In most cases, these are not clearly mapped onto a direct visual representation of the initiative's logic. The same goes for evaluation results. It has been assumed that decision-makers will read indicator and evaluation reports. In the case of evaluation, these can be lengthy and technical reports. The idea then is that decision-makers will map what they remember of these results onto their own mental model of what the initiative is trying to do.

As has been discussed, building a DoView diagram extracts decision-makers' individual mental models and identifies where there are disagreements about how the initiative is actually going about achieving its high-level outcomes. By mapping indicator and evaluation results directly onto the same DoView that decision-makers are using to work out the priorities for action in the next planning cycle, the information is directly available to them when they make those decisions.

Currently, you can map indicator and evaluation results back onto a PowerPoint or Google Slides version of an initiative's DoView, or use the DoView legacy app. In the future, it is hoped that planning and reporting apps, platforms, and systems will include features which integrate indicator databases and evaluation findings with DoView diagram.